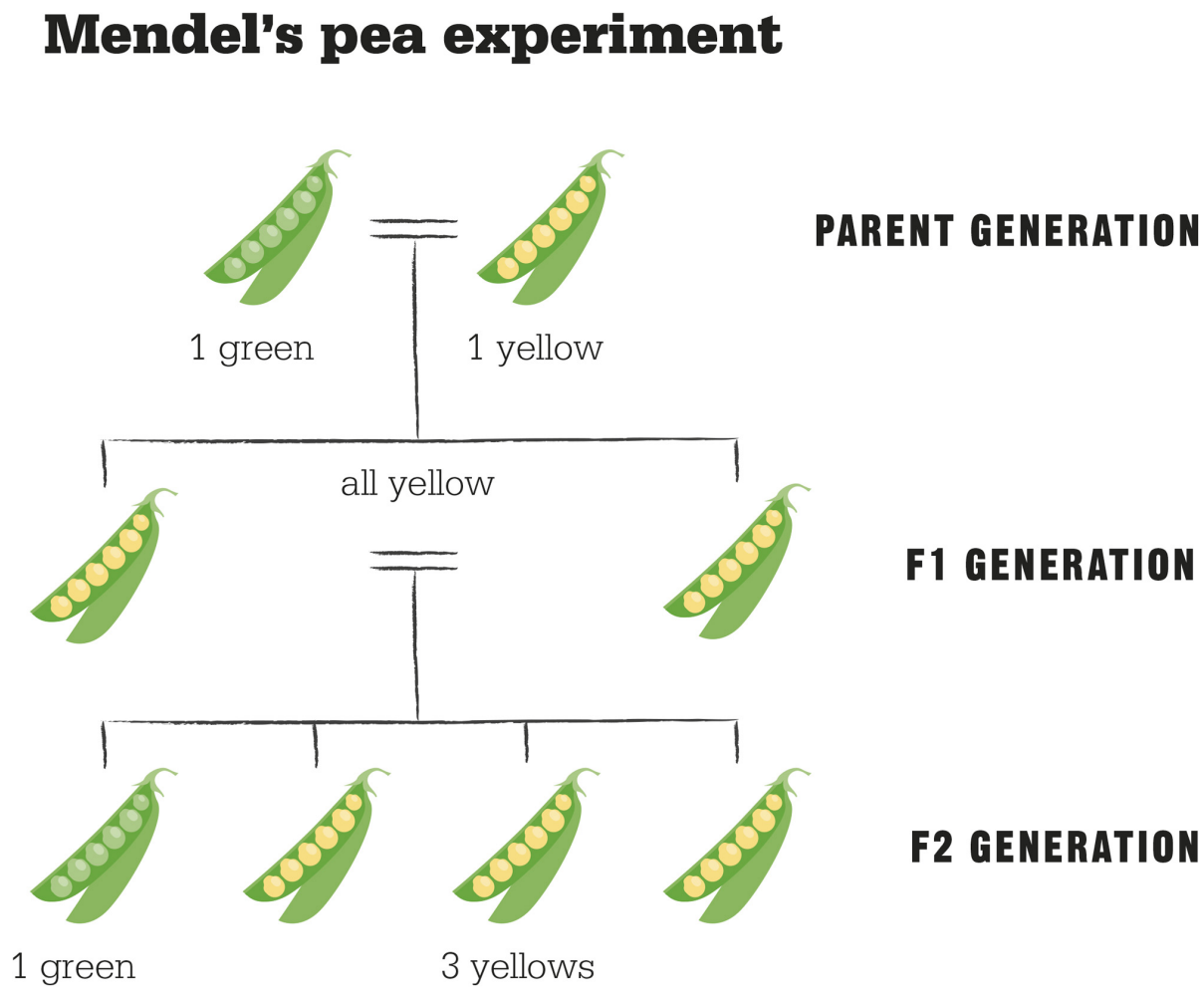
through the generations. By means of much painstaking research, Mendel accurately predicted the basic laws of inheritance.

When Mendel began his experiments, scientists believed that the various traits seen in plants and animals were handed down through a “blending” process. However, Mendel noticed that this was not the case when he was working in his monastery garden. When he crossed a plant that always produced green peas with one that always produced yellow peas, the result was not yellowish-green peas—instead, all the peas were yellow.



Mendel’s experiment with growing peas proved that the gene carrying the yellow coloration was dominant while the gene for green was recessive.

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